

## PHILOSOPHICAL FOUNDATION OF EDUCATION

### IDEALISM (Plato)

- Ideas are the only true reality
- What exist is in the mind only
- Existence of ideas independent from the material world
- Ideas are believed to be innate in the individual as these have been endowed by a perfect thing

#### Sample questions:

1. Teacher Jane is concerned more on conceptual matters since reality is mental.
2. The values education student teaches faith, hope and love and values which are believed to be the permanent values whether they be valued by people or not.

### REALISM (Aristotle)

- Reality exists independent in human mind
- Reality is not in the mind but in the external world
- Ultimate reality is the world of physical objects
- Concern with what is real, what is actual
- Truth is objective – what can be observed

### EMPIRICISM (John Locke)

- Legitimate knowledge arises from what is provided to mind by the senses
- Experience through the use of senses is the source of knowledge
- Only source of knowledge is the senses or sense-based experience

#### Sample questions:

1. In the schools, we teach realities that cannot be verified by the senses like an invincible god or Allah. Whose beliefs does this practice negate?
  - a. Rationalist
  - b. Empiricist
  - c. Skeptics
  - d. Stoicistics

### Existentialism (Soren Kierkegard)

- Reality is subjective, lies within the individual
- Individual choice and standards are central (need to be responsible with the consequences)
- Man's freedom of in the accomplishment of his destiny
- Unique individual

#### Sample questions:

- 1. "Subject matter should help students understand and appreciate themselves as unique individuals who accept complete responsibility for their thoughts, feelings, and actions." from which philosophy is the thought based?
- 2. According to Sartre, "existence precedes essence." teachers who adhere to this philosophical thought is considered as?
- 3. Teacher John views his students as a unique, free choosing and responsible individuals. He encourages them to develop their own individualities. What philosophy does teacher John adhere to?

### Essentialism (William Bagley)

- Going back to the basics
- Focus on 3R's (reading, writing, arithmetic)
- Subject matter is the center of the educational process
- The teacher is the authority, a master of his/her discipline

#### Sample questions:

1. Curriculum's essence is the back to the basic education.
2. Essence preceded existence
3. Philippines' Elementary Curriculum emphasizes on the development of the skill in writing, counting and reading. This manifest the great consideration given to this philosophy.

#### Perennialism (Robert Hutchins)

- Maintains that education involves confronting the problems and questions that have challenged people over the centuries. Thus there is a need to study classical tradition of great books.
- Views education as a recurring process based on eternal truths
- Good education involves a search for and understanding of truth which can all be found in the great works of civilization.
- Its curriculum is fixed and subject-centered relying heavily on the disciplines of literature, math, languages, and history

#### Sample questions:

1. A curriculum should only include those that have survived the test of the time and combine the symbols of literature, history and mathematics. Thus, curriculum like this contains values that are constant and universal. What philosophy describes this kind of curriculum?
2. The school principal emphasizes the importance of the humanities in the curriculum. To which the educational philosophy does he adhere?

#### Pragmatism

- It believes that meaning of an idea can be determined by the consequence of its test: if it works in practice, it is true or good.
- Believes in change as the essence of reality
- Experimental method is its method of thought

#### Sample questions:

- In recent curricular revision, the humanities are gradually replaced by technical courses that bear practical consequences. This shows that curricular direction is toward \_\_\_\_\_.

#### Progressivism (Francis W. Parker) (John Dewey)

- Directly grew from pragmatic philosophy
- Education should focus on the whole child
- Learner is a problem solver who makes meaning through experience
- A learner learns well if through active interplay with others
- Learning by doing principle
- Involves participation of students and allows them to exercise freedom and moral powers
- Methods: Scientific Method and Problem Solving

#### Sample questions:

- Teacher Marie, unlike other teacher in school, practices the non-traditional method of discussing the lessons using not only the book prescribed by the school as the main source of information and knowledge. Instead, she went out her way to devise other means that will help her students to understand better their lessons. To what philosophy does Teacher Marie submit to?
- Teacher has rich philosophical heritage one which advocates the "Learning by Doing": this Philosophy has roots in\_\_\_\_\_.

#### Behaviourism (John B. Watson)

- A behavior can be best explained in terms of responses to external stimuli
- Education can be achieved by modifying or changing student behaviors in socially acceptable manner through the arrangements of conditions of learning
- Human beings are shaped entirely by environment.

#### Sample questions:

- Giving rewards and reinforcements are the primary technique of this philosophical point of view.
- S-R has deep roots in this philosophy
- In a faculty recollection, the teachers were ask to share their thoughts of the learner, their primary costumer. What follow are the gist's of what were shared;

Teacher A: The learner is the product of this environment. Sometimes her has no choice. He is determined by his environment.

Teacher B: The learner can choose what he can become despite his environment

Teacher C: The teacher is a social being who learns well through an active interplay with others.

Teacher D: The learner is a rational being. School should develop his rational and moral powers.

#### Rationalism (Rene Descartes)

- Knowledge can be derived from certain prior truths
- Virtue and happiness can be obtained through the knowledge of God

#### Reconstructivism (George Counts & Harold Rugg)

- Covers the underlying factors that constitute reality or society
- Students are encouraged to become involved in the problems whether political, social, or economical that confronts the society and be able to arrive at solutions in order to reconstruct society
- Declares that the chief purpose of all educational efforts is to "reconstruct" society in order to meet the cultural crisis of times.

Sample questions:

- In line with the philosophy of Reconstructivism, which of the following should be given emphasis in teaching?
  - a. to compare oneself to less fortunate
  - b. to become economically self- reliant
  - c. to designate one's superiority over the others
- \_\_\_\_\_ claims that reality is politically, socially and economically fromed.

Hedonism – pleasure is the only good thing to person

Epicureanism – a form of ancient hedonism – the highest pleasure consists of simple and moderate life; pleasure is attainable only by REASON

Stoicism – if there are difficulties and adversities, you have to patiently accept them and endure them.

Philosophy of LOVE (katuwaan lang ☺)

- Kapag sapat na nasa isip mo siya. IDEALISM
- Kapag dapat nakikita mo siya. REALISM
- Kapag naggagamitan at nagpapractice lang kayo. PRAGMATISM
- Kapag hindi siya kailanman nagbabago. PERRENIALISM
- Kapag nabibigay niya basic needs mo. ESSENTIALISM
- Kapag sayo siya by choice. EXISTENTIALISM
- Kapag hinahayaan mo lang siya sa lahat ng ginagawa para sa ikauunlad niya . PROGRESSIVISM
- Kapag binabago ka niya. BEHAVIORISM
- Kapag ipinahiram mo siya para sa greater good ng greater number. UTILITARIANISM

- Kapag lahat at marami kayong nakikinabang sa kanya, as in sawsawan sya ng bayan. SOCIAL RECONSTRUCTIONISM na yun !

